

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Nuclear power plant emergency

CHEMICAL RADIATION / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Listen to the official alert for your zone and follow instructions to shelter or evacuate. If told to shelter, go indoors and close windows and doors. Take potassium iodide only if public-health officials direct it; it is not a general radiation antidote.

Do now.

**Confirm your zone**

01

Use emergency management and plant-area alerts for your actual address.

**Shelter when directed**

02

Move indoors and follow instructions for outside-air ventilation.

**Evacuate when directed**

03

Use designated routes and reception centers; do not invent a route through restricted areas.

**Follow food and water instructions**

04

Use packaged supplies and heed any local contamination restrictions.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Seek zone-specific radiation information by radio or another verified channel. Radiation cannot be measured by smell or sight. Indoors, close openings and reduce outside-air intake while you establish whether your zone must evacuate; do not self-dose potassium iodide or improvise a route through a suspected release.

Watch for.

Plant emergencies differ from nuclear detonations; a fixed distance or timer is not an all-clear.

People & practical needs.

Keep the family together in the correct shelter for the hazard and separate potentially contaminated items from the living area. Use covered food and safe water. Prepare a bag for relocation, but do not send someone outside for it during an active release. For this situation, brief every person on the first action: confirm your zone. Agree who will manage children, pets or mobility needs while that action happens. Plant emergencies differ from nuclear detonations; a fixed distance or timer is not an all-clear.

Keep essentials within reach.

For nuclear power plant emergency, prioritize only items needed for the first action and the fallback: Seek zone-specific radiation information by radio or another verified channel. Radiation cannot be measured by smell or sight. Indoors, close openings and reduce outside-air intake while you establish whether your zone must evacuate; do not self-dose potassium iodide or improvise a route through a suspected release. Keep the relevant checklist and contact information within reach. Equipment retrieval must not delay the protective step.

Next decisions.

Keep the local emergency plan, routes and alert channels available before an incident.

First decision: Confirm your zone

Use emergency management and plant-area alerts for your actual address. Decide which person can carry this out immediately and what would prevent it in your current location. Do not delay the protective step to complete a household worksheet.

When the original plan fails

Seek zone-specific radiation information by radio or another verified channel. Radiation cannot be measured by smell or sight. Indoors, close openings and reduce outside-air intake while you establish whether your zone must evacuate; do not self-dose potassium iodide or improvise a route through a suspected release. Reassess the next available location or resource using the warning signs in this guide; do not assume a promised service is operating.

Before changing location

Plant emergencies differ from nuclear detonations; a fixed distance or timer is not an all-clear. Check the actual route and the needs of the person who will have the most difficulty moving. A destination is not confirmed until access and conditions have been checked.

Questions in the field.

What matters before collecting supplies?

Listen to the official alert for your zone and follow instructions to shelter or evacuate. If told to shelter, go indoors and close windows and doors. Take potassium iodide only if public-health officials direct it; it is not a general radiation antidote. Collect items only if doing so does not delay this action.

What should another household member do?

Use a second person to handle communication or dependents while the first carries out the immediate action. For nuclear power plant emergency, keep the specific hazard in view: Plant emergencies differ from nuclear detonations; a fixed distance or timer is not an all-clear.

What should be written down?

Record when the situation changed, what action was taken and what remains uncertain. For this situation, start with: Follow food and water instructions. Use packaged supplies and heed any local contamination restrictions. Keep personal notes private; they are not submitted to Osprey Zero.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

Nuclear power plant emergency · official guidance

<https://www.cdc.gov/radiation-emergencies/faq/index.html>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/nuclear-plant-emergency/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.